Engineering *Digest*

March 27 – April 3, 2026 | Weekly Edition | Issue Three | 13 min read

THIS WEEK'S BRIEFING

74%

The share of developers worldwide who have adopted specialised AI coding tools as of January 2026 — JetBrains AI Pulse survey, April 2, 2026

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FOREWORD

Seventy-four percent of developers now use specialised AI coding tools. Universal adoption ought to simplify procurement, but this week proved the opposite. The cheapest frontier coding model turns out to be built on a Chinese open-source foundation that nobody disclosed at launch. The tooling war is being fought on three fronts simultaneously — adoption, cost, and provenance — and most enterprise procurement policies were written before the third front existed.

PRIORITY 0 — ONGOING

AWS Middle East — Day 33+ DEGRADED

Mar 23–24 Second disruption in Bahrain from ongoing drone activity. AWS repeats migration advisory to alternate regions.

Mar 14	Bahrain region 7h+ outage from misconfigured routing (separate incident from original strikes).
Mar 2	AWS confirms structural damage from drone strikes in UAE and Bahrain. Fire suppression caused additional water damage.
Mar 1	Initial drone strikes on UAE facility. Fire, power shutdown, immediate service disruption.

AWS continues to advise all Middle East customers to migrate workloads to alternate regions. No ETA for full restoration. CRN →

ONE THING I'VE BEEN THINKING ABOUT

The JetBrains data shows 74% adoption, but the Pragmatic Engineer survey adds a telling detail: staff+ engineers and directors are the heaviest AI agent users. The people most enthusiastic about Claude Code are the same people signing purchase orders. When the decision-maker and the power user are the same person, procurement frameworks built around committee review may already be obsolete.

THE WEEK AT A GLANCE

Seven Stories in Sixty Seconds

Action required

Security **Node.js 20 reaches end-of-life April 30.** No more security patches after that date. AWS Lambda Phase 1 deprecation begins the same day. Migration to Node.js 24 is recommended — but callback-based Lambda handlers break under the new runtime. *HeroDevs*

Worth knowing

AI **74% of developers have adopted specialised AI coding tools.** GitHub Copilot growth has stalled at 29% workplace usage while Claude Code rocketed to joint second (18%) in eight months. JetBrains AI Pulse survey of 10,000+ developers. *JetBrains*

AI **Cursor's Composer 2 built on Chinese open-source model Kimi K2.5 without disclosure.** The model delivers frontier-level coding at one-tenth the cost of Claude Opus 4.6, but Cursor only acknowledged the Kimi foundation after it was discovered by users. Enterprise procurement teams now need a policy for Chinese-origin AI models. *Business Insider*

AI

OpenAI building desktop "SuperApp" merging ChatGPT, Codex, and Atlas browser into one application. CEO of Applications Fidji Simo told staff that "fragmentation has been slowing us down." *Yahoo Finance*

Fintech

Wise launches UK Current Account with 3.26% variable rate — directly challenging high street banks while over £250bn sits in UK current accounts earning zero interest. Over 3 million active UK customers, £8bn held. *Wise*

Watching

DevTool

Anthropic ships Claude Code auto mode — an AI classifier approves safe actions automatically and blocks risky ones, reducing the permission fatigue that led developers to skip guardrails entirely. Research preview for Teams. *Anthropic*

Platform

Node.js moves to one major release per year starting with Node 27 in April 2027. Every release becomes LTS. The odd/even distinction — and the confusion it caused — is gone. *Node.js*

AI TOOLING & ADOPTION

The AI Tooling War Has a Winner. Your Procurement Team Missed It.

74%	29%	18%	$0.50
Developer adoption of AI coding tools	Copilot workplace usage	Claude Code workplace usage	Composer 2 per 1M input tokens

Adoption Is Universal — Growth Is Not

JetBrains published its latest AI Pulse survey data on April 2, drawing on responses from more than 10,000 developers across eight languages. The headline number: 74% of developers worldwide have adopted specialised AI coding tools — editors, assistants, and

ENTERPRISE AI CODING COSTS COMPARED

Tool	Per-seat pricing
GitHub Copilot	$19/seat (Business) $39/seat (Enterprise)
Claude Code	$20–25/seat

agents — as of January 2026. A further 90% use at least one AI tool (including chatbots) for development work.

Tool	Per-seat pricing
Cursor	$40/seat (Pro) Custom (Enterprise)

But adoption figures mask a dramatic shift in market share. GitHub Copilot remains the most widely recognised tool (76% awareness) and holds the largest single share at 29% workplace usage. That number has barely moved in a year. Copilot's strongest position is in enterprises over 5,000 employees, where it reaches 40% — driven overwhelmingly by procurement defaults, not developer choice.

Claude Code's Eight-Month Ascent

Claude Code, which didn't exist before mid-2025, has reached 18% workplace adoption — matching Cursor for joint second place globally and hitting 24% in the US and Canada. Its customer satisfaction score is the highest in the survey: 91% CSAT and a net promoter score of +54. The Pragmatic Engineer's parallel survey of 900+ engineers tells a similar story: Claude Code is the most-used tool, with directors and VPs among the most enthusiastic adopters.

> *"GitHub Copilot growth has stalled since last year. Claude Code adoption increased 6x from April–June 2025 to January 2026."*
>
> — JetBrains AI Pulse Survey, April 2, 2026

The Kimi Question

Then there's Cursor's Composer 2. Launched in late March, it was marketed as "frontier-level at coding" at a fraction of the cost: $0.50 per million input tokens versus $5 for Claude Opus 4.6. What Cursor didn't disclose at launch was that Composer 2 was built on Kimi K2.5, an open-source model from Chinese startup Moonshot AI. Cofounder Aman Sanger later acknowledged on X that "it was a miss to not mention the Kimi base in our blog from the start." Only about a quarter of the compute came from the base model, with Cursor's own reinforcement learning training on top — but the provenance disclosure gap raises a procurement question that many enterprises haven't yet been forced to answer.

Three-Way Tension

Engineering directors making tooling decisions in 2026 face a tension that didn't exist eighteen months ago. Developers increasingly prefer Claude Code. Procurement teams default to Copilot because it's the known quantity with a Microsoft contract attached. And the market's cost frontier is

being pushed by models built on open-source Chinese foundations — capable, cheap, and sitting outside most enterprise AI governance policies. The Kimi episode is the first visible collision between these three forces. It will not be the last.

So what: The AI coding tools market has moved from "should we adopt?" to a three-way contest between developer preference, procurement defaults, and model provenance — and most enterprise tooling policies haven't caught up with any of them.

Sources: JetBrains, Pragmatic Engineer, Business Insider, TechCrunch

QUICK TAKES

Two Stories Worth Knowing

Banking & Fintech

£250bn

In UK current accounts earning 0% interest

Wise Takes On High Street Banks

Wise launched its UK Current Account on March 30, offering a 3.26% variable rate on GBP balances — a direct challenge to the high street banks sitting on over £250bn in zero-interest current accounts. The numbers behind the move are substantial: more than 3 million active UK customers, £8bn held in Wise accounts, and over £4bn already earning interest through Wise Assets.

The current account comes packaged with Airport Lounge Pass access and Young Explorer cards for under-18s, both launched after sustained customer demand. Wise's real-time payment infrastructure already delivers 74% of global payments in under 20 seconds — a

Security Alert

April 30

Node.js 20 end-of-life date

Node.js 20 — 27 Days to End of Life

Node.js 20 reaches end-of-life on April 30 — 27 days from today. After that date, no more official security patches or vulnerability fixes. AWS Lambda Phase 1 deprecation begins the same day, blocking the creation of new Lambda functions on the nodejs20.x runtime. Phase 2 follows in August; Phase 3 in September.

The recommended migration target is Node.js 24, not 22 — Node.js 22's own EOL arrives in April 2027, uncomfortably close. But Node.js 24 introduces a breaking change: callback-based Lambda handlers (`exports.handler = function(event, context, callback)`) no longer work. Every

capability that most traditional banks are still years away from matching at scale.

So what: Wise has built the multi-currency real-time infrastructure that traditional banks are spending years trying to modernise, and is now competing directly on the most defended product in retail banking — the current account.

Wise Newsroom

Lambda function using the legacy callback pattern needs rewriting to async/await.

Separately, Node.js announced it is moving to one major release per year starting with Node 27 in April 2027. Every release becomes LTS. The confusing odd/even system is retired.

So what: Any team running production workloads on Node.js 20 without a migration plan has a 27-day security deadline — and the migration path to Node.js 24 includes a breaking change that affects every Lambda function using the legacy callback pattern.

HeroDevs, CloudQuery, Node.js

42%

The share of committed code that is now AI-generated or assisted, up from 6% in 2023. Developers predict this will reach 65% by 2027. — Sonar State of Code 2026

OTHER NEWS THIS WEEK

In Brief

OpenAI consolidating ChatGPT, Codex, and Atlas browser into a desktop "SuperApp" — ending product fragmentation ahead of its planned IPO at a $730bn valuation. *Let's Data Science*

Anthropic launched Claude Code auto mode — a two-layer classifier system that approves safe actions automatically while blocking risky ones, aiming to solve the permission fatigue that led developers to skip guardrails entirely. *Anthropic*

Sonar's 2026 State of Code survey: 72% of developers who have tried AI coding tools now use them every day, with 42% of committed code AI-generated or assisted. *SonarSource*

Africa's first Islamic neobank Nyla selected Mambu for its SaaS core banking platform ahead of its Ghana launch in June 2026. *Fintech Futures*

PLATFORM UPDATES

At a Glance

Status	Platform	What changed
🔴	**Node.js 20**	End-of-life April 30, 2026 — no more security patches
🔴	**AWS Lambda**	Node.js 20 runtime Phase 1 deprecation April 30
🟠	**Node.js**	Release schedule changing: one major per year from Node 27 (2027)
🟢	**Node.js 25**	Released with V8 14.1, `--allow-net` permission model, Web Storage default

THE LEADERSHIP READ

The Tool Your Developers Want vs. The Tool Procurement Approves

The data is in — and it tells two different stories

JetBrains' AI Pulse survey, published April 2, gives engineering leaders the clearest picture yet of what's actually happening with AI coding tools. The headline — 74% adoption — sounds like consensus. Beneath it, there's a widening gap between what developers choose and what enterprises buy.

GitHub Copilot holds 76% awareness and 29% workplace usage, but that number has flatlined. At companies over 5,000 employees, Copilot reaches 40%, largely because procurement teams select it as the default via existing Microsoft agreements. Meanwhile, Claude Code — barely eight months old — has hit 18% globally and 24% in the US and Canada, with a 91% customer satisfaction score and a net promoter score of +54, the highest in the survey.

The agent adoption gap

The Pragmatic Engineer's parallel survey of 900+ engineers adds a layer the JetBrains data doesn't fully capture. Staff+ engineers are the heaviest users of AI agents, at 63.5%. Directors and VPs are especially enthusiastic about agentic tools. Most engineers juggle two to four AI tools simultaneously; 15% use five or more. The era of a single company-approved tool is over in practice, even where it persists in policy.

> *"GitHub Copilot growth has stalled since last year. Claude Code increased adoption 6x from April–June 2025 to January 2026, achieving the highest satisfaction score of any tool in the survey."*
>
> — JetBrains AI Pulse Survey, April 2, 2026

Cursor's 35% growth advantage

Cursor is growing 35% faster than Copilot per the Pragmatic Engineer data, driven by developers who prize speed and cost-effectiveness over procurement convenience. And Cursor's trajectory raises the sharpest question of all: its newest model is built on a Chinese open-source foundation that most enterprise AI governance policies don't yet address.

The pattern across both surveys is consistent: developers are adopting tools faster than procurement can evaluate them, and the tools developers prefer are frequently not the ones procurement approves.

Read the full survey: JetBrains →

Read the full survey: Pragmatic Engineer →

This could be worth talking about: *If your developers are choosing Claude Code and your procurement team is approving Copilot, who is making the actual tooling decision for your organisation?*

OUTSIDE IN

Clerk's Reliability Reckoning

When routine infrastructure fails silently

Clerk, the authentication-as-a-service provider used by thousands of applications, published a post-mortem on March 13 for a service outage three days earlier. The root cause was a failed live migration of a Google Cloud SQL virtual machine — a routine operation performed by Google without advance

notice. The migration caused a spike in disk latency, which cascaded into database lock contention and a complete outage.

This was not Clerk's first recent incident. A similar Cloud SQL live migration had caused problems in September 2025. The database was pinned to prevent further migrations until January 2026, then unpinned. Three months later, the same failure mode struck again.

> "Clerk has faced several incidents recently and frustration is rightfully mounting. We have failed at our commitment to customers and we are deeply sorry. Customers depend on Clerk for critical infrastructure, and we have not lived up to that responsibility."

Masking failure state

A technical detail in the post-mortem is worth noting: during the outage, Clerk's system returned 429 (rate limit) status codes instead of 500 (server error) codes. The 429s bubbled up from an internal service rather than being transformed to accurately represent the failure. Applications relying on those error codes to assess Clerk's health were getting a misleading signal — the system looked throttled when it was actually down.

The leadership decision

CEO Colin Sidoti announced that the majority of Clerk's engineering team would shift to reliability-focused projects, with new product features explicitly delayed as a consequence. For an infrastructure provider in a competitive market, pausing feature development is a significant strategic cost — and an acknowledgement that reliability debt had outpaced the roadmap.

So what: When an infrastructure provider's routine operation fails silently and takes your platform down, the response that matters is whether you're willing to redirect your entire engineering team to reliability and tell customers that features will be late.

Read the full post: clerk.com →

ON THE RADAR

Coming Up

APR **14** — **Patch Tuesday** — Microsoft April security update cycle

APR — **Node.js 20 end-of-life** — last day for official security patches

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APR 30 — **AWS Lambda Node.js 20 Phase 1 deprecation** — no new functions on nodejs20.x runtime

MAY 19 — **QCon London 2026** — May 19–21

JUN 02 — **Apple WWDC 2026**

RECOMMENDED READING

This Week's Links

AI Tooling for Software Engineers in 2026	pragmaticengineer.com
DORA metrics tools in 2026: What to measure, and what's missing	getdx.com
The State of Banking Technology in 2026	ccgcatalyst.com

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